

3. Design: Ditch your personal notion of art and aesthetics, in UX design, it is only about how it works. Functionality and feel are the stars of the show, style and fashion aren't even in the picture! Make the visuals as intuitively obvious as possible. Capture and channel the user's attention. Be consistent in your design and follow the other design principles, as you will learn. Make the design trustworthy and test users to know if you are conveying the intended message in the intended manner.

4. Copywriting: This is an often overlooked ingredient of UX that can make a big difference. UX copy is different from the normal copywriting that you use in advertisements and on websites to convey the brand message and company image. UX copy is only concerned with being functional, saying as much as necessary in as little words as possible. Short and sweet. A good UX copy sounds confident and motivates the user. Now go out and write some! (After you've read the rest of this Fast Track..)

5. Analysis: Often this is the weakest spot of most UX designers, as it is also the most powerful weapon, so sharpen your analysis skills well. Analysis is done not just on the subjective user research, but also on the objective data collected after the first run, as they each answer different types of questions. Be careful to be honest with yourself, and avoid the confirmation bias, where you are just using the numbers to prove yourself right. Look for bad results as well as good results, and use relative numbers to track the effect of changes over time.

UX Design - The Myths of the Matter

1. The User comes first.

While this is one of the key ideas of UX that is thrown around so much that it borders on propaganda, there is one missing fact. The business goals come first. Though you aren't being asked to pick sides, you have to align the fulfillment of the user's goals with the business goals, not vice versa. After all, if the business doesn't sustain itself, how will you get paid? And if you don't get paid, how will you delight your users?

2. Ask the Users what they want.

The problem with this idea is summarized in a quote by the late, great, Henry Ford. "If I'd asked my customers what they wanted, they'd have said a faster horse." You can't directly ask your users what they want, because people